

APRIL 2026 COMMON MONTHLY ASSESSMENT

**UNITED STATES HISTORY AND
GOVERNMENT**

Student Name _____

Date _____

The possession or use of any communications device is strictly prohibited when taking this examination. If you have or use any communications device, no matter how briefly, your examination will be invalidated and no score will be calculated for you.

Print your name and the date on the lines above. A separate answer sheet for Part I has been provided to you. Follow the instructions from the proctor for completing the student information on your answer sheet. Then fill in the heading of each page of your essay booklet.

This examination has two parts. You are to answer all questions.

Part I contains **9** multiple-choice questions. Record your answers to these questions as directed on the answer sheet.

Part II has been excluded from this test.

Part III is based on several documents:

Part III A contains the documents. When you reach this part of the test, enter your name on the first page of this section. Each document is followed by one question. Write your answer to each question on the lines following that question.

Part III B contains one essay question based on the documents.

DO NOT OPEN THIS EXAMINATION BOOKLET UNTIL THE SIGNAL IS GIVEN

Base your answers to question 1 on the cartoon below and on your knowledge of social studies.

“The Big Stick in the Caribbean Sea”



Source: W. A. Rogers, 1904 (adapted)

- 1 This cartoon reflects the foreign policy belief that the United States should
 - (1) oppose independence movements in Latin America
 - (2) remain neutral in the affairs of Latin America
 - (3) become the protector of the Western Hemisphere
 - (4) annex the countries of the Western Hemisphere

Base your answers to questions 2 and 3 on the image below and on your knowledge of social studies.

Women picket in front of the White House for their right to vote in 1917



Source: Library of Congress (adapted)

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>2 The main goal of the women's rights movement in the early 20th century was to achieve</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) political equality(2) equal pay for equal work(3) improvements in living conditions(4) better job opportunities | <p>3 Which statement best represents a reason why this protest was considered controversial?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) The Senate had already repealed the Prohibition amendment.(2) The country was dealing with public outrage over government corruption.(3) President Wilson did not include women's demands in his Fourteen Points.(4) Suffragists were picketing while German submarines were attacking American ships. |
|---|--|

Base your answers to questions 4 and 5 on the map below and on your knowledge of social studies.

Patterns of African American Migration from the South, 1910–1970



Source: Siegel, Rutgers Cartography, 2005 (adapted) promise, 1820

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>4 What was a main reason for the movement of people as shown on this map?</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none">(1) Foreign food imports replaced domestic production of crops.(2) Northern states banned all forms of racial discrimination.(3) Abolitionists promised a means of escape from slavery.(4) Industrialization provided more employment opportunities | <p>5 What was one result of the migration shown on the map?</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none">(1) The South became the new destination for most European immigrants.(2) The Democratic Party declined in the northern half of the country.(3) American culture was enriched by new forms of music and literature.(4) Segregated communities throughout the nation came to an end. |
|---|--|

Base your answers to questions 6 and 7 on the excerpt below and on your knowledge of social studies.

. . . The most stringent [strict] protection of free speech would not protect a man in falsely shouting fire in a theatre and causing a panic. . . . The question in every case is whether the words used are used in such circumstances and are of such a nature as to create a clear and present danger that they will bring about the substantive [real] evils that Congress has a right to prevent. . . .

Source: Supreme Court Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes, Majority Opinion, *Schenck v. United States*, 1919 (adapted)

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>6 In this decision, the actions of Charles Schenck were labeled as a “clear and present danger” because the United States was</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) responding to strikes by organized labor(2) implementing a new immigration system(3) involved in fighting a world war(4) concerned about a revolution in Russia | <p>7 Which constitutional right was limited by this Supreme Court decision?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) freedom of expression(2) right to bear arms(3) right to counsel(4) trial by jury |
|---|---|

Base your answers to questions 8 and 9 on the excerpt below and on your knowledge of social studies.

. . . So, first of all, let me assert my firm belief that the only thing we have to fear is fear itself—nameless, unreasoning, unjustified terror which paralyzes needed efforts to convert retreat into advance. In every dark hour of our national life a leadership of frankness and vigor has met with that understanding and support of the people themselves which is essential to victory. I am convinced that you will again give that support to leadership in these critical days.

Source: President Franklin D. Roosevelt, First Inaugural Address, March 4, 1933 (adapted)

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>8 Which program was created in response to the situation described in this speech?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) Fourteen Points(2) New Deal(3) Manifest Destiny(4) Great Society | <p>9 What issue is being addressed by President Franklin D. Roosevelt in this speech?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) the failure of Prohibition(2) the economic problems caused by the Great Depression(3) the destruction caused by the attack on Pearl Harbor(4) the possibility of a military alliance with Great Britain |
|---|--|

NAME: _____

DATE: _____

PART III

CIVIC LITERACY ESSAY (Questions 10-13)

This Civic Literacy Essay Question is based on the accompanying documents. The question is designed to test your ability to work with historical documents. Some of these documents have been edited for the purpose of this question. As you analyze the documents, take into account the source of each document and any point of view that may be presented in the document. Keep in mind that the language and images used in a document may reflect the historical context of the time in which it was created.

Historical Context: Prohibition

Throughout United States history, many constitutional and civic issues have been debated by Americans. These debates have resulted in efforts by individuals, groups, and governments to address these issues. These efforts have achieved varying degrees of success. One of these constitutional and civic issues is Prohibition.

Task: Read and analyze the documents in Part A. Using information from the documents and your knowledge of United States history, answer the questions that follow each document in Part A. Your answers to the questions will help you write the Part B essay in which you will be asked to

- Describe the historical circumstances surrounding this constitutional or civic issue
- Explain one effort by individuals, groups, and/or governments to address this constitutional or civic issue
- Discuss the impact of the effort on the United States and/or on American society

In developing your answers to Part III, be sure to keep these general definitions in mind:

- (a) **describe** means “to illustrate something in words or tell about it”
- (b) **explain** means “to make plain or understandable; to give reasons for or causes of; to show the logical development or relationships of”
- (c) **discuss** means “to make observations about something using facts, reasoning, and argument; to present in some detail”

Civic Literacy Essay
Part A
Short-Answer Questions (10–12)

Directions: Analyze the documents and answer the short-answer questions that follow each document in the space provided.

Document 1

. . . The prohibition movement was an outgrowth of the temperance crusades of the first half of the nineteenth century. Hard drinking was almost the rule among the Fathers of the Republic. The per capita consumption of spirits in the early days was many times what it is now, and beer drinking was almost unknown. After the War of 1812, there grew up in the New England States a large commerce in West Indian rum, which was consumed extensively, especially in Maine, supplementing the consumption of heavy liquors which were manufactured in those States. Maine alone, in 1827, when her population was 360,000, manufactured 1,333,160 gallons of liquor, and it was sold at retail in nearly every store and tavern. Drunkenness in its worst form, involving disastrous social consequences, was widespread. Sufficient evidence of it was to be found in the number of persons in the jails and poorhouses. . . .

Source: L. Ames Brown, "Prohibition," *The North American Review*, November 1915

- 10 According to L. Ames Brown, what is *one* historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition?

Score

--

Document 2

. . . The Women’s Organization for National Prohibition Reform (WONPR) was founded in 1929 to show that not all women supported temperance. New York socialite Pauline Sabin led the charge after hearing Ella Boole, the Brooklyn-based leader of the Women’s Christian Temperance Union, declare that her support for Prohibition represented “the women of America.” On the heels of the successful suffrage campaign that won women the right to vote in 1920, the WONPR, and Sabin in particular, reflected the modern “new woman” of the 1920s. Many members of the WONPR had in fact initially supported the 18th amendment. But they had come to believe that Prohibition had led to a surge in unregulated and particularly underage drinking, as well as a growing sense of distrust for the rule of law. The WONPR’s opposition to Prohibition, just like the 18th amendment itself, was not only about drinking, but about the government’s role in regulating behavior. The WONPR did a lot of what we think of now as typical political campaign activities: members attended meetings and gave speeches at rallies, went door-to-door to recruit new supporters, used new technology to spread their message—at the time radio, and lobbied politicians. Wealthy women had founded the organization, and proved able to raise funds even after the Stock Market Crash of 1929 ushered in the Great Depression. From its headquarters in New York City, the organization also gained publicity by organizing events such as a motorcade through New York State. . . .

Source: Sarah Seidman, “The New York Women Who Dismantled Prohibition,”
Museum of the City of New York, December 15, 2015

11 According to Sarah Seidman, what was **one** effort to address Prohibition?

Score

Document 3

. . . The end of the Prohibition era marked the demise of a moral crusade meant to impose a uniform standard of social behavior in the United States. Unrealistic and unforgiving, Prohibition had allowed a vocal minority to regulate the personal habits of all Americans, especially those who lived and worked in cities like New York. While the desire of the dry crusade to uplift and improve the United States by banning alcohol and the saloon had in some ways been understandable in the Progressive era that spawned the Prohibition movement, the shortcomings of the dry crusade manifested themselves as soon as the dry experiment had begun. Anachronistic [outdated] and unworkable, the Prohibition experiment was ill suited to the diversity and dynamic of the modern United States, which by the 1920s had grown too large and too varied a nation to be governed by an impulse as intrusive as the dry crusade. Despite the force of federal law, the use of authoritarian tactics to enforce it, and the expenditure of millions of dollars a year, in fourteen years Prohibition succeeded neither in changing Americans' behavior nor in eliminating the problems caused by alcohol abuse. When Prohibition failed, and it did so spectacularly, it revealed the limits of moral reform movements, and specifically the paternalistic, prejudiced, and undemocratic ideals behind the dry crusade. . . .

Source: Michael A. Lerner, *Dry Manhattan: Prohibition in New York City*, Harvard University Press, 2007

12 According to Michael A. Lerner, what has been ***one*** impact of the efforts to address Prohibition?

Score

Part B

Civic Literacy Essay Question (13)

Directions: Write a well-organized 3 paragraph essay that includes an introduction, one paragraph, and a conclusion. Use evidence from at least three documents in the body of the essay. Support your response with relevant facts, examples, and details. Include additional outside information.

Historical Context: Prohibition

Throughout United States history, many constitutional and civic issues have been debated by Americans. These debates have resulted in efforts by individuals, groups, and governments to address these issues. These efforts have achieved varying degrees of success. One of these constitutional and civic issues is *Prohibition*.

Task: Using information from the documents and your knowledge of United States history, write an essay in which you

- Describe the historical circumstances surrounding this constitutional or civic issue
- Explain efforts by individuals, groups, and/or governments to address this constitutional or civic issue
- Discuss the impact of the efforts on the United States and/or on American society

Guidelines:

In your essay, be sure to

- Develop all aspects of the task
- Explain *at least one* effort to address the issue
- Incorporate information from *all three* documents
- Incorporate relevant outside information
- Support the theme with relevant facts, examples, and details
- Use a logical and clear plan of organization, including an introduction and a conclusion that are beyond a restatement of the theme